



Cambridge International Examinations
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/33

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2018

2 hours

READING BOOKLET INSERT

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Reading Booklet Insert and use the blank spaces for planning.
This Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.



This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the passage carefully, and then answer **Question 1, Section 1** on the Question Paper.

Can adults praise children too much?

The following passage is an article from a magazine about education, and it explores the issue of praise.

Most parents and teachers agree that praise is critical to developing children's self-esteem, so the more praise the better. Right?

Not necessarily, according to some psychologists and teachers. Praising everything children do does not build self-esteem. Eventually the praise becomes meaningless. Instead of continually praising students, teachers should encourage specific improvements in their students' work. Here experts debate the question: 'To praise or not to praise?'

Although praise is obviously good for children, if adults applaud everything children do, some child professionals say that the praise can eventually lose its effect or create 'approval junkies', youngsters who constantly seek praise. As one counsellor in a large secondary school said of such students, 'Their self-worth is based on what others say, and that is not a healthy sort of self-esteem. These students can't do anything unless they are praised for it.'

Rather than responding to all of children's work with phrases such as 'Good job!' or 'Nice work!', some researchers advise that teachers should consider using comments that pinpoint weaknesses and flaws which need attention.

The common notion is that children with high self-esteem will be happier and perform better in school and later in life and that praise is one route to achieving this. However, one psychologist, Dr Davies, claims that self-esteem does not make children happier, achieve more, or become more capable and competent, although it does help them to deal with stressful situations and to build some resilience.

Identifying a child's strengths and developing those strengths helps build confidence more than constant praise does, according to Dr Davies. Praise also loses its effect if the praise is the same for all the students. For example, if all the students in a class are told their paintings are great and students know some are better than others, the praise will lose its significance.

'Honest feedback, delivered sensitively, is far more beneficial in the long run than empty praise,' says Dr Davies. 'Adults have got into the habit of not telling children when they are wrong, and that will not help them cope with adversity when they are adults. That's not how the real world works.'

Although the idea that the praise which children receive should be more selective and specific is not new, it is starting to overtake the notion that more praise is always better. 'Blanket, automatic, or empty praise is useless and children easily see through it,' says Benjamin Li, another expert researching this area. 'The praise has to be grounded in something real.' However, he wouldn't want to see the pendulum swing back to the other extreme, where teachers withhold praise for genuine accomplishments.

Not everyone, though, agrees that less praise is more beneficial. Kirsten Xiang, another psychologist, says that given a choice, she would always opt for giving children more praise. 'My concern is that people will not praise children at all. I have adult patients who report that they were not praised as children. If I have to err, I would err on the side of over-praising.'

Xiang does admit there is a possibility that too much praise could make children jaded and less prepared for the rigours of adult life. 'If a child has been working hard on vocabulary and comes home with an A, it is appropriate to praise and point out the connection with hard work,' she says. 'But if the child normally does well in vocabulary, there is no need to be effusive.'

Despite what some researchers say, Stephanie Marchant, a teacher in a school for children with learning difficulties, says she can see the impact of praise on students every day. 'I'm like a cheerleader all day. The praise keeps them going. When they hear 'you're wonderful', 'good job', or 'you're so smart', it's always meaningful – I can tell by the looks on their faces. They are more likely to try harder or take risks in their learning.' That kind of constant encouragement might not be as important in a mainstream class, Marchant says, but she believes all children benefit from steady praise. 'I would err on the side of praising more.'

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Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

No Additional Materials are required.

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do not use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **two** questions in the space provided: **Question 1** in **Section 1** and **one** question from **Section 2**.
If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Question 1** in **Section 1** on the Question Paper.

The Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **11** printed pages, **1** blank page and **1** Insert.



Question 1

In your letter, you should:

- Base your letter on what you have read in the passage, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

[illegible]

[Total: 25]

[Turn to page 6 for Section 2]

Section 2: Composition**Questions 2, 3, 4 and 5**

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this Question Paper.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Descriptive Writing

- 2 On your way to a friend's house, you decide to take a different route and find yourself lost in an unfamiliar area for a few minutes. Describe your surroundings and your thoughts and feelings in these few minutes before you find your way again.

OR

- 3 Write a description with the title, 'Through the Window'.

OR

Narrative Writing

- 4 Write a story that begins with an unexpected delay on a journey.

OR

- 5 Write a story which ends with the words, '... if only I had listened.'

Please write your chosen question number here (2, 3, 4 or 5):

Blank lined paper for writing.

[illegible]

Additional Page

If you use the following lined page to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

[illegible]

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